

Assessment Book — French Revolution

History | Grade 9-10

Questions

Total marks 98

Q1. (6 marks) According to the conventional dates given in the text, state the event and exact date commonly used to mark the start of the French Revolution, and the event and exact date commonly used to mark its end. (6 marks)

Q2. (3 marks) Explain, using evidence from the chapter, how social, economic/financial and political factors combined to create the crisis that led to the Revolution. In your answer give one example of each type of factor and explain briefly how they interacted to produce revolutionary pressure. (3 marks)

Q3. (1 mark) Between the calling of the Estates-General in May 1789 and the formation of the National Constituent Assembly, which list correctly identifies at least three concrete actions the Third Estate actually took during that sequence of events?

- A. They verified and registered their deputies, broke away from the Estates-General to sit separately as the National Assembly, and took the Tennis Court Oath promising not to disperse until a constitution was written.
- B. They immediately declared a republic, seized arms in Paris, and abolished feudal dues without waiting for any written constitution or assembly procedures.
- C. They joined the clergy and nobility in voting by order, accepted the king's demand to adjourn, and disbanded once the royal session ended.
- D. They produced the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen in May, invited foreign armies to enforce reforms, and abolished the monarchy on the day of the Estates-General opening.

Q4. (6 marks) Using the chapter's description, explain why the Storming of the Bastille on 14 July 1789 became a potent symbol of the Ancien Régime even though the fortress held very few prisoners. In your answer, refer to the role of newspapers, pamphlets and the deliberate creation of revolutionary symbols.

Q5. (3 marks) Briefly describe the immediate legal changes enacted by the August Decrees regarding feudal dues and church tithes, and name one practical difficulty reported in implementing these changes. (3 marks)

Q6. (1 mark) How did the confiscation of church property and the issuance of assignats affect France's fiscal crisis and inflation during the Revolutionary period?

- A. The Assembly used confiscated church lands to back assignats, which temporarily provided funds and national control over property but were overissued, undermined confidence, and contributed to severe inflation until later monetary reforms restored stability.
- B. Confiscating church property immediately ended France's fiscal problems and

permanently stabilized the currency because the assignats were fully reliable substitutes for metal coinage.

- C. The assignats were unrelated to fiscal policy; they were only a social measure to redistribute land and had no effect on government revenue or prices.
- D. Assignats prevented inflation by replacing tithes and tax farming with a uniform paper currency, so prices fell and economic disruption was avoided.

Q7. (6 marks) Summarise the main emergency measures used by the Revolutionary government during the Reign of Terror (September 1793–July 1794) and the human costs they produced. Your answer should use specific figures and dates drawn from the period (for example arrests, tribunal executions, known massacre numbers, and the dates of key laws or executions). (6 marks)

Q8. (3 marks) Compare the two interpretations in the chapter about what primarily drove the French Revolution — (A) Enlightenment ideology (radical Enlightenment) or (B) pragmatic responses to immediate crises — and give one piece of evidence the chapter uses to support each interpretation. (3 marks)

Q9. (1 mark) According to the chapter's discussion of mobilization between 1792 and 1795, how did wartime mobilization change the scale of the French military and the political dynamics inside France?

- A. Mobilization reduced the size of the army but increased local political power, because professional officers were dismissed and municipalities ran recruitment.
- B. Mobilization only modestly increased troop numbers while leaving political power largely unchanged; the government relied on traditional volunteer enlistment instead of mass conscription.
- C. Mobilization massively enlarged the revolutionary armies—from tens of thousands to several hundred thousand through measures like the 1793 levée en masse—and concentrated power in central revolutionary bodies, linking military success to radical politics and state control.
- D. Mobilization created a large foreign mercenary force that defended the monarchy and slowed revolutionary change, because most French citizens refused to serve and the government hired outsiders.

Q10. (6 marks) Analyse how metropolitan debates over rights influenced events in the French Caribbean, especially Saint-Domingue, and explain the main policy responses taken between 1791 and 1793. In your answer, show how metropolitan actors and ideas interacted with colonial actors and describe at least two concrete policy actions taken in this period.

Q11. (3 marks) Explain two specific ways the 1791 constitutional settlement limited the king's power during the Constitutional Monarchy phase (July 1789 – 2 September 1792). Then give one clear reason why these limits helped create political tensions that contributed to the king's loss of authority by September 1792. (3 marks)

Q12. (1 mark) Which statement best explains the immediate political consequence of King Louis XVI's flight to Varennes in June 1791?

- A. The king's attempt to escape was exposed at Varennes and greatly increased public suspicion of him, weakening his authority and pushing many revolutionaries to distrust the monarchy.

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B. The escape attempt at Varennes succeeded in rallying most French citizens behind the king, who was seen as a victim of revolutionary disorder and therefore regained strong popular support.

- C. News of the Varennes incident had little impact on French politics because most people believed Louis XVI had legitimate reasons to travel and accepted his explanations.
- D. The flight to Varennes immediately brought strong military aid from foreign monarchs, allowing Louis XVI to reassert control over the Revolution within months.

Q13. (6 marks) On 22 September 1792 the National Convention declared the end of the monarchy and the beginning of the French First Republic, and the revolutionaries introduced a new way of dating events by starting Year One (1792). Explain the significance of this proclamation and the introduction of Year One. In your answer, show how the proclamation changed political authority and why creating a new calendar mattered for the revolution. (6 marks)

Q14. (3 marks) Briefly explain what is meant by the Thermidorian reaction after Robespierre's fall. In your answer, give specific political actions and outcomes associated with this reaction.

Q15. (1 mark) Which feature of the French Directory most directly explains why it relied on the army and was vulnerable to the coup of 18 Brumaire (1799)?

- A. A five-member executive whose limited authority and internal divisions made civilian rule weak, combined with political unrest and economic problems that pushed leaders to use the army.
- B. A strong executive president who centralized power but lost legitimacy because the bicameral legislature refused to fund the army during economic crisis.
- C. A single-chamber legislature that concentrated power and created stability, but the Directory used the army only to suppress external threats, not domestic politics.
- D. A broadly popular government with stable finances that nonetheless suffered isolated corruption scandals, leading to a small military intervention that removed it.

Q16. (6 marks) Explain the role of women during the French Revolution. In your answer describe the forms of women's activism (including named authors or agitators), their participation in demonstrations and clubs, and how revolutionary governments responded in the 1791 and 1793 constitutions and in October 1793. (6 marks)

Q17. (3 marks) Describe two long-term impacts of the French Revolution on France and/or Europe. For each impact, give one clear explanation of how the Revolution produced that change. (3 marks)

Q18. (6 marks) Using the Encyclopaedia Britannica article 'French Revolution | History, Summary, Timeline, Causes, & Facts', identify and explain three main causes of the French Revolution that the article emphasises. For each cause, show how the article connects that cause to the outbreak of revolution in 1789.

Q19. (3 marks) Using the bibliography entry 'Opie, Robert Frederick (1997). Guillotine. History Press.' explain why this entry represents a monograph. In your answer (a) identify the author, year, title and publisher, and (b) give two features of the entry that indicate it is a monograph rather than an article or an edited chapter.

Q20. (6 marks) Explain the main empirical findings of Acemoglu, Cantoni, Johnson, and Robinson (2011) in 'The Consequences of Radical Reform: The French Revolution', and summarise the mechanisms the authors propose to link the revolutionary reforms to long-run economic outcomes in affected regions. Your answer should refer to the evidence they use and outline at least two mechanisms they emphasise. (6 marks)

Q21. (6 marks) The document contains an "Extensive bibliography on the French Revolution." In a short essay (about 2–3 paragraphs), explain how such an extensive bibliography can help a student understand the range of historiographical approaches to the French Revolution. Identify at least three distinct features of the bibliography that reveal different approaches or perspectives, and explain briefly why each feature matters for interpreting the Revolution.

Q22. (6 marks) According to the text, which specific events and dates are conventionally cited as the start and the end of the French Revolution? Give both the event name and its date for the start and for the end.

Q23. (6 marks) Using evidence from the chapter, explain how social, economic, financial and political factors combined to produce the crisis that led to the Revolution. In your answer show how resistance to reform and indecisive royal policy made the situation worse. (6 marks)

Q24. (6 marks) Analyse the sequence of events from the calling of the Estates-General in May 1789 through the Tennis Court Oath to the formation of the National Constituent Assembly. In your answer identify at least three concrete actions the Third Estate took during this process and explain how those actions advanced their move from estate delegation to a national assembly. (6 marks)

Answer Key — teacher copy, not for distribution to students

Answer Key

Q1.

Answer: Start: The Storming of the Bastille on 14 July 1789. End: Napoleon Bonaparte's coup of 18 Brumaire, which took place on 9 November 1799 (the conventional end of the Revolution).

Rubric — Accuracy in recalling the conventional start and end events and their exact dates.

Full credit (6 marks): Clearly names the Storming of the Bastille and gives the exact date 14 July 1789, and clearly names Napoleon's coup of 18 Brumaire and gives the exact date 9 November 1799.

Partial credit (3 marks): Either (a) correctly gives one event with its correct date (e.g. Bastille and 14 July 1789 OR 18 Brumaire/coup and 9 November 1799) OR (b) names both events but gives an incorrect or missing date for one or both.

No credit (0 marks): Fails to identify either conventional event and date correctly (answers are incorrect, unrelated, or left blank).

Q2.

Answer: Social: Rising inequality and public anger at privileges of the nobility and clergy — for example, urban workers and peasants faced high food prices and resented tax exemptions for elites. Economic/financial: A chronic fiscal crisis — repeated deficits from costly wars and an inefficient tax system left the state near bankruptcy, requiring unpopular borrowing and

attempted reforms. Political: Indecisive royal policy and resistance to reform — ministers' fiscal reforms were blocked by privileged estates and royal vacillation, producing stalemate.

Interaction: Economic hardship increased popular grievances (social), while the crown's inability to implement fair taxation (political) prevented resolution of the fiscal crisis, so anger at privilege and failed reform combined to radicalise opinion and precipitate revolution. (All points supported by chapter examples: food price rises, state deficits, blocked reform attempts and protests.)

Rubric — Explains one social, one economic/financial and one political factor and shows briefly how they interacted to produce revolutionary crisis, using chapter evidence.

3 marks (3 marks): Identifies a clear social factor, a clear economic/financial factor, and a clear political factor drawn from the chapter (each named or quoted). Explains succinctly how these three interacted to create crisis (links economic hardship to social grievance and political failure to resolve it) and includes at least one chapter example or detail.

2 marks (2 marks): Identifies two of the three required factors clearly and the third partially (e.g., named but not exemplified). Gives a reasonable explanation of interaction between factors but with limited evidence from the chapter (one example or a general reference).

1 mark (1 marks): Names at least one relevant factor from the chapter (social, economic/financial or political) with minimal or no explanation of interaction and little or no chapter evidence; answer shows understanding but is fragmentary.

Q3.

Correct: A. They verified and registered their deputies, broke away from the Estates-General to sit separately as the National Assembly, and took the Tennis Court Oath promising not to disperse until a constitution was written.

A. Correct — each action is documented: Third Estate deputies checked and verified their membership rolls, declared themselves the National Assembly when they broke from the traditional order structure, and after being locked out they took the Tennis Court Oath to stay assembled until a constitution was agreed.

B. This option mixes later revolutionary outcomes and myths: the Third Estate did not immediately proclaim a republic or universally seize arms at that moment, nor did they unilaterally abolish feudal dues before constitutional work; those were later, sometimes separate, developments.

C. This describes the opposite of what happened. The Third Estate refused to vote by order (they wanted head-count voting), did not simply accept an adjournment, and did not disband — instead they asserted a new assembly.

D. This option contains chronological errors and false actions: the Declaration was not produced in May (it was adopted in August 1789), they did not invite foreign armies, and the monarchy was not abolished at the Estates-General opening.

Q4.

Answer: Although the Bastille contained only a small number of prisoners when it was taken on 14 July 1789, the chapter shows that its fall became a powerful symbol of the Ancien Régime for several linked reasons. First, contemporary newspapers and pamphlets amplified the event: reporters and revolutionary writers spread vivid accounts and rumours that exaggerated the Bastille's role as a site of political repression, so the public came to see its capture as the overthrow of despotism rather than merely the seizure of a small prison. Second, the revolutionary press and print culture deliberately redefined meanings and promoted new symbols to replace old-regime imagery; descriptions of the Bastille's fall were integrated into a

wider symbolic programme (alongside the tricolour and the liberty cap) that turned concrete events into shared political mythology. Third, pamphleteers and illustrators framed the Bastille as a physical embodiment of monarchical and clerical tyranny, giving the crowd's action clear moral and political significance beyond any immediate practical result. Together, sensational reporting, deliberate symbolic construction, and the circulation of images and stories explain why the Bastille's fall became a lasting emblem of the Ancien Régime despite the fortress's small real role as a prison.

Rubric — Explanation of why the Bastille's fall became a potent symbol, citing media and symbolic construction from the chapter.

Excellent (6 marks) (6 marks): Explains clearly and specifically that the Bastille held few prisoners but became a potent symbol because newspapers and pamphlets amplified and sensationalised the event, popular rumours exaggerated its role, and revolutionary actors deliberately created and promoted new symbols (e.g. linking the Bastille with the tricolour and liberty cap). Uses the chapter's points about print culture and symbolic redefinition to connect media amplification with the transformation of a local action into national political mythology.

Partial (3 marks) (3 marks): States that the Bastille held few prisoners and that publicity made it symbolic. Mentions newspapers/pamphlets or the deliberate creation of symbols, but explanation is incomplete or fails to link media amplification to the deliberate symbolic programme described in the chapter, or gives only general statements without specific reference to how print culture created the myth.

Insufficient (0 marks) (0 marks): Fails to recognise that the Bastille held few prisoners or offers only factual errors (for example, claiming it held many political prisoners) and gives no coherent explanation of the role of newspapers, pamphlets, or symbolic construction from the chapter.

Q5.

Answer: The August Decrees legally abolished feudalism by cancelling feudal dues and ended the obligation to pay church tithes; they also established legal equality (ending the seigneurial privileges). A practical difficulty in implementing these measures was local resistance and confusion over enforcement and compensation—landowners and clergy disputed what exactly was cancelled and how clergy were to be compensated (leading to reliance on assignats), making on-the-ground application uneven and contentious.

Rubric — Accuracy of the two legal changes named and the realism/specificity of the implementation difficulty.

Full credit (3 marks): Clearly states both immediate legal changes (abolition/cancellation of feudal dues and abolition/end of church tithes, with mention of equality before the law or end of seigneurial privileges) and gives one specific, plausible practical difficulty (e.g. local resistance, enforcement confusion, disputes over compensation and use of assignats) showing how implementation was problematic.

Partial credit (2 marks): States one correct legal change (either abolition of feudal dues or abolition of church tithes) or states both changes but gives a vague or generic difficulty (e.g. 'it was hard to implement' without explaining how).

No credit (0 marks): Fails to name either correct legal change or gives an incorrect/irrelevant difficulty (e.g. claims the decrees created new feudal dues or that assignats immediately solved all fiscal problems without noting implementation issues).

Q6.

Correct: A. The Assembly used confiscated church lands to back assignats, which temporarily provided funds and national control over property but were overissued, undermined confidence, and contributed to severe inflation until later monetary reforms restored stability.

A. Correct: This explains that confiscated church property backed assignats, provided short-term funds, but

overissue and loss of confidence led to severe inflation and disruption until later reforms (e.g., the Franc germinal) improved stability.

B. This is incorrect because it treats assignats as a permanent, reliable fix; the common misconception is to ignore overissue and inflation—the assignats did not permanently stabilise the currency.

C. This is incorrect because it separates assignats from fiscal policy; in reality the Assembly intended assignats to raise revenue by using nationalised church lands as backing, so they were central to fiscal policy and affected prices.

D. This is incorrect because it reverses the real effect: assigning a paper currency did not prevent inflation or restore price stability—overissue and loss of confidence caused severe inflation and economic disruption.

Q7.

Answer: Between September 1793 and July 1794 the Revolutionary government used a set of emergency measures to suppress perceived internal enemies. Key measures included the Law of Suspects (September 1793), which broadened grounds for arrest and led to mass imprisonment (around 300,000 people are estimated to have been arrested under Terror policies). Revolutionary tribunals carried out summary trials and executions: tribunal records indicate roughly 16,500–17,000 judicial executions in 1793–1794 (with notable spikes after the Law of 22 Prairial, passed on 10 June 1794, which simplified procedures and increased convictions). Extra-judicial repression also occurred: the Nantes drownings (often dated to 1793–1794) are estimated at around 1,800–2,000 victims, and there were many deaths in prisons and in the Vendée rising; when combined with executions the wider death toll of the Terror is commonly estimated at about 30,000–40,000. The period also included high-profile political purges used as examples: the Hébertists were executed in March 1794, Danton and his allies were executed on 5 April 1794, and Robespierre himself fell and was executed on 28 July 1794, which ended the Terror. In short, emergency legislation (Law of Suspects, Revolutionary tribunals, and the Law of 22 Prairial) produced mass arrests (c. 300,000), thousands of judicial executions (c. 16,500–17,000) and several thousand extra-judicial deaths (e.g. Nantes c. 1,800–2,000), contributing to a total death toll often placed in the tens of thousands by historians.

Rubric — Accuracy and use of specific figures and dates to summarise measures and human costs of the Reign of Terror

Excellent (6 marks): Clearly identifies the main emergency measures (Law of Suspects, Revolutionary tribunals, Law of 22 Prairial) with correct dates and links each to human costs using at least three specific and plausible figures (e.g. arrests ~300,000; tribunal executions ~16,500–17,000; Nantes drownings ~1,800–2,000 or total deaths ~30,000–40,000). Includes one or two named executions/dates (e.g. Danton 5 Apr 1794, Robespierre 28 Jul 1794).

Satisfactory (3 marks): Names the main measures and gives at least one correct specific figure or date (for example arrests or tribunal executions) but is missing some figures, gives a less precise total, or omits one of the key laws or a named execution; shows general understanding but with limited use of specific evidence.

Limited (1 marks): Gives a vague description of repression without accurate dates or figures, or provides incorrect numerical claims; may mention one event (e.g. Robespierre's execution) but fails to connect measures to concrete human costs.

Q8.

Answer: Interpretation A (Enlightenment ideology): The chapter argues that radical Enlightenment ideas about natural rights and popular sovereignty provided the language and

principles that inspired revolutionary actors; evidence cited is the influence of Enlightenment authors and the way the Declaration of the Rights of Man echoes those authors' language. Interpretation B (pragmatic responses to immediate crises): The chapter maintains that practical problems — social, economic, financial crises, resistance to reform, and indecisive royal policy — were the main drivers of revolutionary action; evidence cited is the chapter's account of fiscal collapse and widespread food shortages that provoked popular unrest and forced political breakdown.

Rubric — Compare the two interpretations and provide one piece of evidence from the chapter for each.

Full credit (3 marks): Clearly states both interpretations (Enlightenment ideology and pragmatic crises) and gives one specific, relevant piece of evidence from the chapter for each (e.g. influence of Enlightenment authors/Declaration wording for ideology; fiscal collapse/food shortages or indecisive royal policy for pragmatic causes).

Partial credit (2 marks): States both interpretations but provides only one piece of evidence total or gives two pieces of evidence that are vague or not clearly tied to the chapter's claims (e.g. mentions 'ideas' and 'crisis' without the chapter examples).

Minimal/no credit (0 marks): States only one interpretation or gives no relevant evidence from the chapter.

Q9.

Correct: C. Mobilization massively enlarged the revolutionary armies—from tens of thousands to several hundred thousand through measures like the 1793 levée en masse—and concentrated power in central revolutionary bodies, linking military success to radical politics and state control.

A. Incorrect: this reverses the main trends. Mobilization expanded army size rather than reducing it, and central organs (not localities) gained coercive and administrative power over recruitment and resources.

B. Incorrect: this understates the scale and political effect. The chapter describes a rapid, large increase in forces driven by mass measures (not merely volunteers) and significant shifts in power toward central revolutionary institutions.

C. Correct: the chapter links the 1793 levée en masse and related measures to a jump from prewar and early-war forces measured in tens of thousands to revolutionary armies numbering in the hundreds of thousands. That military expansion went together with centralization (e.g., stronger revolutionary committees, requisitioning, and political oversight of the army) and with the politicization of military success.

D. Incorrect: this is misleading. The enlarged armies were largely French and mobilized by conscription and volunteers inspired or compelled by revolutionary policy; they did not consist primarily of foreign mercenaries defending the monarchy.

Q10.

Answer: Metropolitan debates about rights — between revolutionary reformers (including the Society of the Friends of the Blacks and some Jacobins) and pro-colonial, slaveholding interests — directly shaped events in the Caribbean by polarising opinion, provoking colonial resistance, and creating practical policy dilemmas for Paris. In Saint-Domingue the 1791 enslaved uprising (August 1791) erupted into a large-scale revolt that intersected with metropolitan disputes over whether rights should extend to free people of colour or to enslaved people. Colonial planters formed pro-slavery lobby groups and militias to defend their privileges; metropolitan abolitionists and some legislators argued for extending civil rights, while others in Paris sought to avoid wrecking the colonial economy. In response, the revolutionary government attempted a mix of concessions, coercion and administrative intervention rather than immediate universal

emancipation. Key policy responses 1791–1793 included: (1) legislative and administrative debate and limited concessions in Paris on the status of free people of colour (metropolitan bodies debated and in practice some decrees and votes in 1791–1792 addressed their civil rights), which intensified planter hostility; (2) dispatch of republican commissioners to the colony (notably Sonthonax and Polverel in 1792) with instructions to preserve the colony for the Republic — they combined military measures with political measures, using offers of freedom to enslaved people who supported republican forces and issuing local emancipation measures in 1793 in areas under their control; and (3) increasingly radical national rhetoric and policy from Paris that opened the way for commissioners to take emancipationist steps. These responses show a contested process: metropolitan debates produced inconsistent and sometimes contradictory policies, colonial resistance shaped how measures were implemented, and commissioners on the ground made pragmatic, sometimes unilateral choices (including conditional or local emancipation) before the Convention's formal abolition of slavery in 1794. Historians differ on emphasis — some stress metropolitan ideology as the driver, others the agency of colonial actors and commissioners — but the evidence supports a reciprocal influence where metropolitan debates framed possibilities and colonial crises pushed policy toward emancipationist measures by 1793.

Rubric — Explanation of how metropolitan debates affected Saint-Domingue and description of policy responses 1791–1793, with evidence and nuance.

Excellent (6 marks): Clearly explains the link between metropolitan debates and colonial events in Saint-Domingue, names relevant metropolitan groups and colonial actors, describes at least two specific policy responses (e.g. debates/limited concessions on free people of colour, dispatch of commissioners in 1792, commissioners' conditional/local emancipation measures in 1793), and shows nuance about contested interpretations and implementation; uses specific evidence and causation.

Satisfactory (3 marks): Explains that metropolitan debates influenced colonial unrest and policy; mentions either the 1791 uprising and/or commissioners being sent and at least one policy response (e.g. partial rights for free people of colour or commissioners' actions), but treatment is incomplete, lacking some specifics or nuance about contested interpretations or implementation.

Limited (1 marks): Provides minimal or general statements linking metropolitan debates to colonial events, or only lists events without connecting them (e.g. mentions the 1791 revolt or 1794 abolition without describing 1791–1793 policy responses), with little supporting evidence or analysis.

Q11.

Answer: Two ways: 1) The 1791 Constitution transferred sovereign law-making power from the king to an elected Legislative Assembly, so the king could no longer make laws independently. 2) The constitution restricted political participation by creating 'active' and 'passive' citizens, so only active citizens (paying a certain tax and meeting age/ residence requirements) could vote, limiting the king's popular political support and altering the balance of power. One reason these limits increased tensions: by cutting real political power and narrowing the electorate, the constitution intensified disputes over who represented the nation; combined with events like the Flight to Varennes (June 1791) and fears that the king sympathised with émigrés and foreign powers, many revolutionaries lost trust in the monarchy and pushed for its removal, leading to the king's loss of authority by 1792.

Rubric — Identifying two constitutional limits on the king and explaining one reason those limits heightened tensions leading to loss of royal authority.

Full marks (3 marks): Provides two distinct, accurate limits imposed by the 1791 constitutional settlement (e.g.

law-making moved to the Legislative Assembly; clear description of active vs passive citizens or the king's suspensive veto/ministerial responsibility) and gives one clear, historically grounded reason linking these limits to increased political tensions (mentions loss of trust, Flight to Varennes, émigrés/foreign intervention fears, or widening revolutionary pressure) that contributed to the king's loss of authority.

Partial credit (2 marks): Gives two limits but at least one is incomplete or vague, or gives one correct limit and a correct reason; the connection to political tension is stated but not clearly linked to events like the Flight to Varennes or suspicion of royal collusion.

Minimal credit (1 marks): Gives only one correct limitation of royal power or only a brief, general reason why tensions rose (e.g. 'people didn't trust the king') without connecting to constitutional changes or specific events.

Q12.

Correct: A. The king's attempt to escape was exposed at Varennes and greatly increased public suspicion of him, weakening his authority and pushing many revolutionaries to distrust the monarchy.

A. Correct — Contemporary reports and later historical accounts show that being caught at Varennes convinced many citizens and revolutionaries that the king was disloyal to the Revolution; this loss of trust weakened his authority and accelerated moves against the monarchy.

B. This is incorrect because the opposite occurred: being caught fleeing made many people view Louis as betraying the nation, not as a victim, so it did not rally broad popular support.

C. This is incorrect because the Varennes affair did change public opinion; it undermined the king's credibility. Few influential groups accepted his explanations after the escape failed.

D. This is incorrect because while foreign monarchs were sympathetic, no immediate foreign military intervention restored Louis's control within months; the main effect was political distrust inside France, not an external rescue.

Q13.

Answer: On 22 September 1792 the Convention formally abolished the monarchy and proclaimed the French First Republic, transferring sovereignty from a hereditary king to the nation and its elected representatives. Politically this marked a decisive break with the ancien régime: it removed the legal basis for royal authority, justified later actions such as the trial and execution of Louis XVI, and opened the way for new republican institutions and a politics based on popular sovereignty. The decision to start dating events from Year One (1792) was a symbolic and practical attempt to show that history itself had been reset; it legitimised revolutionary changes by framing them as the beginning of a new era and helped to de-Christianise public life by replacing the old calendar tied to the church. Historians offer competing interpretations: some view the proclamation and new dating as the culmination of revolutionary radicalisation and an assertion of ideological rupture, while others argue they were pragmatic responses to the collapse of monarchical authority and the need to unify the nation in wartime. In short, the proclamation transformed where political legitimacy was claimed to lie, and the Year One calendar reinforced that transformation by making the revolution's break with the past visible in everyday civic life.

Rubric — Explanation of the political significance of the 1792 proclamation and the symbolic/practical importance of introducing Year One, using contextual evidence and recognising different interpretations.

Excellent (6 marks): Clearly explains how the 22 Sept 1792 proclamation transferred sovereignty from the monarchy to the nation and why that was a decisive political break; explicitly explains the purpose and meaning of starting Year One (symbolic reset, legitimising revolutionary change, de-Christianising/public symbolism);

supports claims with contextual evidence (e.g. link to trial of Louis XVI, new republican institutions) and notes at least one competing interpretation. Answer is balanced and directly addresses both parts of the question.

Satisfactory (4 marks): Explains that the monarchy was abolished and a republic proclaimed and states that Year One marked a new beginning or was symbolic; gives some context or consequence (for example mentions further actions against the king or change in legitimacy) but treatment of either the political change or the calendar is limited or lacks supporting evidence or interpretation.

Limited (1 marks): Gives a basic factual statement such as 'the monarchy ended and Year One began' with little or no explanation of significance, context, consequences, or alternative interpretations; answer is fragmentary or largely descriptive.

Q14.

Answer: The Thermidorian reaction was the political backlash after Robespierre's fall in which moderates and returned elites rolled back the most radical features of the Terror. It included local revenge killings (notably in southern France) and the execution or removal of leading members of the Paris Commune, the repeal of the Law of 22 Prairial which restored legal protections, the forced closure and weakening of the Jacobin Club, and a diplomatic shift toward negotiated peace treaties rather than continued revolutionary war.

Rubric — Accuracy and completeness in describing the key political actions and outcomes of the Thermidorian reaction

Full credit (3 marks): Clearly defines the Thermidorian reaction as a post-Robespierre political backlash and mentions at least four of the required specifics: local revenge killings (e.g. in southern France), executions/removal of Commune leaders, repeal of the Law of 22 Prairial, closure/weakening of the Jacobin Club, and a shift to negotiated peace treaties.

Partial credit (2 marks): Correctly identifies the Thermidorian reaction as a political reaction and gives two or three of the required specifics (for example: repeal of the Law of 22 Prairial and closure of the Jacobin Club, or revenge killings and removal of Commune leaders), but omits other key outcomes or lacks clarity.

Minimal credit (1 marks): Gives a very general statement that the Thermidorian reaction was a backlash against the Terror with only one specific example or a vague description without connecting it to specific actions.

Q15.

Correct: A. A five-member executive whose limited authority and internal divisions made civilian rule weak, combined with political unrest and economic problems that pushed leaders to use the army.

A. Correct — the Directory's executive was five directors with limited, divided authority; faced with chronic unrest, economic weakness, violence, and corruption, civilian leaders often relied on the army, which made a military coup possible.

B. Error: invents a strong executive president; in reality the executive was weak and collective (five directors).

The legislature did not simply refuse funding as the main cause; the problem was weakness and reliance on the army amid instability.

C. Error: misstates the legislature's structure (the Directory era had two chambers) and wrongly claims stability. The Directory was unstable and used the army in domestic politics, not only for external threats.

D. Error: contradicts evidence about popularity and finances. The Directory was not broadly popular or financially stable; corruption and economic crisis were chronic and led to heavy reliance on the army, not an isolated intervention.

Q16.

Answer: Women were active and visible agents during the Revolution in several connected ways. As writers and agitators they produced political texts and petitions—for example Olympe de Gouges published the Declaration of the Rights of Woman (1791) and advocated for legal equality, while women like Madame Roland influenced opinion in political salons. Women also took part directly in street politics: the Women’s March on Versailles in October 1789 is a clear instance of collective action where market women and other protesters forced the royal family to move to Paris. From 1790 onwards women formed political clubs and societies (for example the Society of Revolutionary Republican Women) and organized meetings, petitions and demonstrations to press economic and political demands. Despite this activism, successive revolutionary authorities limited women’s formal political rights: the 1791 Constitution framed active citizenship in male terms and did not extend the vote or full political rights to women; the 1793 Constitution, while more radical in some social language, likewise did not grant women political rights. The response hardened in October 1793 when revolutionary authorities banned women’s clubs and suppressed many organized female political activities, partly because leaders (e.g., some Jacobins) viewed outspoken women as a threat to public order and to revolutionary definitions of citizenship. Historians debate these developments: some argue women’s activism demonstrates an expanded political culture that nonetheless excluded women legally, while others emphasize that the Revolution ultimately reasserted a gendered public sphere by denying formal rights and suppressing women’s associations.

Rubric — Accuracy and depth in explaining women’s activism, key examples, and government responses (1791, 1793, Oct 1793), with contextual interpretation.

Excellent (6 marks): Clearly explains multiple forms of women’s activism (names at least one author/agitator such as Olympe de Gouges or Madame Roland), describes participation in a major demonstration (e.g. Women’s March on Versailles) and women’s clubs, states the exclusion of women in the 1791 and 1793 constitutions, and explains the October 1793 ban on women’s clubs; offers brief contextual interpretation of causes or consequences. (All elements present and accurate.)

Satisfactory (3 marks): Describes at least two forms of activism (for example writers and demonstrations OR clubs and a demonstration) and mentions that constitutions did not grant political rights or that clubs were later banned, but omits one key element (a named example, a date, or the October 1793 ban) or gives only minimal interpretation of causes/consequences.

Limited (1 marks): Makes only brief or vague statements about women’s role (e.g. ‘women protested’ or ‘women wrote pamphlets’) with little or no specific examples, and fails to correctly state the constitutional exclusions or the October 1793 suppression; offers no contextual interpretation.

Q17.

Answer: 1) Abolition of feudal privileges and reshaping French society: the Revolution ended the legal basis of feudalism, leading to the redistribution or sale of much church and aristocratic land and a decline in aristocratic legal privileges, which opened opportunities for peasants and the bourgeoisie and altered the social hierarchy. 2) Spread of nationalism and modern state ideas across Europe: revolutionary ideas about popular sovereignty, citizenship and the nation inspired nationalist movements and encouraged the formation of modern nation-states; French armies and Napoleonic reforms also exported legal and administrative institutions (e.g. the Napoleonic Code) that influenced other countries.

Rubric — Accuracy and explanation of two distinct long-term impacts of the French Revolution

Full credit (3 marks): Gives two distinct long-term impacts and for each provides a clear, specific explanation linking the impact to how the Revolution caused it (e.g. ending feudal privileges leading to land/ social change;

spread of nationalism and institutions such as the Napoleonic Code).

Partial credit (1 marks): Gives one clear long-term impact with a correct explanation, or gives two impacts but with only brief or vague explanation(s) that do not clearly link cause and effect.

No credit (0 marks): Response is incorrect, irrelevant, or blank; fails to identify any valid long-term impact or explanation.

Q18.

Answer: 1) Fiscal crisis and government debt: Britannica emphasises that long-term state debt, driven by costly wars (including support for the American Revolution) and an inefficient tax system, left the monarchy unable to balance its budget. The article links this financial collapse to 1789 by showing that the need for new revenue forced Louis XVI to call the Estates-General, which created a political crisis and opened space for revolutionary action.

2) Social inequality and the ancien régime structure: The article highlights the divisions between the three estates (clergy, nobility, and commoners), the privileges of the First and Second Estates, and the burdens placed on the Third Estate. Britannica connects this to 1789 by arguing that widespread resentment among commoners—over taxation, legal inequalities, and lack of political voice—helped turn fiscal problems into popular mobilisation when the Estates-General met.

3) Enlightenment ideas and political culture: Britannica points out that Enlightenment critiques of absolute monarchy, calls for rights and representative government, and debates about sovereignty shaped public opinion. The article links these intellectual currents to 1789 by explaining that Enlightenment ideas informed the language and aims of revolutionary actors (for example the National Assembly and the Declaration of the Rights of Man), helping transform economic and social grievances into a programme for radical political change.

Rubric — Identifying and explaining three main causes from the Britannica article and linking each cause to the 1789 outbreak

Full marks (6 marks): Provides three distinct causes named in the Britannica article (fiscal crisis/debt, social/estates inequality, Enlightenment ideas or equivalent). For each cause gives a clear explanation grounded in the article and explicitly explains how the article links that cause to the outbreak in 1789 (e.g. Estates-General called due to debt; popular resentment of the Third Estate; Enlightenment shaping revolutionary aims).

Partial credit (3 marks): Provides two of the three main causes from the article, or three causes but with one weak or incorrect link to 1789. Explanations are present but lack clear grounding in the Britannica account or only one cause is explicitly connected to the outbreak.

Minimal credit (1 marks): Provides only one valid cause from the Britannica article and/or gives very brief or vague explanations; connections to the 1789 outbreak are absent or incorrect; shows limited understanding of the article's emphasis.

Q19.

Answer: Author: Robert Frederick Opie. Year: 1997. Title: Guillotine. Publisher: History Press. This is a monograph because it is a single, standalone book by one named author (no journal title, volume/issue, or editor listed), and the entry gives a publisher rather than a journal or edited collection—both features indicate a whole book-length work rather than an article or a chapter in an edited volume.

Rubric — Identification of bibliographic elements and explanation of two features showing the entry is a

monograph.

Full credit (3 marks): Correctly identifies author (Robert Frederick Opie), year (1997), title (Guillotine) and publisher (History Press), and gives two correct, specific features explained (e.g. single named author/no editor or chapter title; presence of a publisher and no journal/volume/issue), showing why this indicates a monograph.

Partial credit (2 marks): Identifies most bibliographic elements (at least two of author, year, title, publisher) and gives one correct feature that indicates a monograph or lists two features without clear explanation.

No credit (0 marks): Fails to identify bibliographic elements correctly and/or gives incorrect or irrelevant reasons (e.g. refers to journal details that are not present).

Q20.

Answer: Acemoglu et al. (2011) find that areas exposed to more intense revolutionary violence and radical reform during the French Revolution experienced persistently lower economic development and different political behaviour in the long run compared with less-exposed areas. Empirically, they show that communes closer to massacre sites and where revolutionary authorities implemented radical policies (for example, confiscation of properties and replacement of local elites) had lower levels of public goods provision, lower wealth indicators, and were less likely to vote for redistributionist parties even a century later. The authors support causality using geographic and historical variation (distance to epicentres of violence, timing of reforms), instrumental variables, and tests that rule out simple pre-revolutionary differences.

They propose two main mechanisms. First, a human-capital and elite-attrition mechanism: radical violence destroyed or drove out local elites and skilled administrators, disrupting investments in public goods and institutions; this loss of human capital reduced economic development. Second, a political-institutional mechanism: harsh revolutionary experiences changed political preferences and social trust, making populations more conservative about redistribution and less willing to support collective investment, which in turn affected long-term public goods provision and economic performance. The paper points to supporting evidence for both mechanisms (e.g. changes in occupational composition, slower recovery of public services, and altered voting patterns), and discusses how these interact rather than being mutually exclusive.

Rubric — Understanding of main findings and explanation of mechanisms linking radical reform to long-run outcomes, with reference to evidence

Full credit (6 marks): Clearly states the key empirical findings (long-run negative economic and political effects in highly exposed areas) and correctly describes at least two mechanisms (e.g. loss of elites/human capital and changed political preferences/institutions). Refers to the types of evidence used (variation in exposure, distance to violence, instrumental strategies, voting and public-goods data) and connects evidence to mechanisms.

Partial credit (3 marks): Gives a partial or imprecise account of findings (mentions long-run effects or political change but not both) and describes one mechanism or mentions two superficially without linking to evidence. Limited reference to empirical strategies or data.

No credit (0 marks): Fails to identify the paper's main findings or mechanisms, or gives inaccurate claims (e.g. attributes effects to unrelated causes) and provides no reference to the evidence used.

Q21.

Answer: An extensive bibliography helps the student see that historians approach the French Revolution from many angles rather than as a single agreed story. Three clear features that reveal this diversity are: (1) the variety of types of works listed (books, journal articles, edited

collections, doctoral theses, and primary-source editions). This matters because books often present broad synthetic interpretations, articles advance focused arguments or new evidence, theses sometimes contain original archival work, and primary-source editions enable students to check evidence themselves—together these types show both synthesis and ongoing debate. (2) The range of topical focuses (political institutions and leaders, social and economic change, cultural and intellectual history, regional studies, gender and popular movements). This matters because it demonstrates competing causal explanations: for example, political-institutional accounts emphasize events and elites, social or economic studies stress class and material conditions, and cultural or gender studies highlight meanings, identities, and lived experience. Recognising these topics helps a student compare explanations and see how they complement or contradict one another. (3) The presence of different interpretive traditions and national or chronological perspectives (e.g., older Marxist or revolutionary-society interpretations, revisionist or cultural-history works, comparative studies placing France in a European or Atlantic context). This matters because historiographical traditions frame questions and evidence differently—Marxist accounts foreground class struggle and long-term structures, revisionists question teleological narratives and emphasise contingency, while comparative work situates the Revolution among broader processes. By noting these features, a student can map debates, evaluate evidence, and understand that interpretations depend on methods, sources, and questions the historian chooses.

Rubric — Identifying and explaining how features of the bibliography reveal different historiographical approaches to the French Revolution.

Excellent (6 marks): Clearly identifies at least three distinct features of the bibliography (types of works, topical range, interpretive traditions/national or chronological perspectives) and explains, with specific and relevant reasoning for each, why each feature matters for understanding competing historiographical approaches. Shows awareness of how these features affect questions, evidence, and causal claims about the Revolution.

Satisfactory (3 marks): Identifies two features of the bibliography and gives plausible explanations for why they matter to historiography, but explanations are partial or lack depth; may mix features or give general statements without linking them firmly to interpretation or types of evidence.

Limited (1 marks): Identifies at most one relevant feature or gives vague/general comments about a bibliography without explaining how it reveals different historiographical approaches; reasoning is unclear, superficial, or incorrect.

Q22.

Answer: The conventional start given in the text is the Storming of the Bastille on 14 July 1789. The conventional end given in the text is Napoleon Bonaparte's coup of 18 Brumaire (9 November 1799).

Rubric — Accuracy in recalling the conventional start and end events and their dates as stated in the text.

Full credit (6 marks): Names both the correct events (Storming of the Bastille; Napoleon's coup of 18 Brumaire) and gives both correct dates (14 July 1789; 9 November 1799).

Partial credit (3 marks): Names one event with its correct date, or names both events but gives an incorrect date for one of them (for example, correct events but wrong day/month/year for one).

No credit (0 marks): Fails to name either of the conventional events, or gives both events and dates incorrectly or leaves the answer blank.

Q23.

Answer: The Revolution grew out of an interlinked crisis across social, economic, financial and

political spheres. Financially, long wartime spending (especially after the Seven Years' War) and the costs of supporting the American War left the royal treasury deeply in deficit; ministers' attempts to raise revenue through broad-based taxation were blocked, producing repeated fiscal emergencies. Economically and socially, poor harvests, rising bread prices and stagnant wages increased popular hardship and peasant unrest, while the burden of indirect taxes and feudal dues fell disproportionately on the Third Estate. Politically, the monarchy faced paralysis: elite resistance (notably from the parlements and privileged nobility) blocked reforms proposed by ministers such as Turgot and Calonne, and Louis XVI's vacillation meant reforms were introduced too late or half-heartedly. Resistance to reform therefore amplified the financial crisis (because needed tax changes failed) and deepened social grievances (because economic pain was not relieved). Although Enlightenment ideas and political pamphlets helped shape how people understood injustice, they were not the sole cause; rather, ideological currents interacted with concrete fiscal collapse, worsening living conditions, and a political system unable to resolve the crisis. These combined factors produced widespread mobilization and the collapse of royal authority that led to Revolution.

Rubric — Explanation of how social, economic, financial and political factors combined to produce the revolutionary crisis, using chapter evidence and addressing resistance to reform and royal indecision.

Excellent (6 marks): Clearly explains how financial collapse, economic hardship, social inequality and political paralysis interacted. Uses specific evidence from the chapter (e.g. wartime debts, failed ministerial reforms, poor harvests, tax burdens, parlements' resistance, Louis XVI's indecision) and links these causes to show how resistance to reform and indecisive royal policy intensified the crisis.

Partial (3 marks): Identifies two or three relevant factors (for example financial problems and social hardship, or political resistance and taxation) and gives some evidence from the chapter, but explanation is incomplete or links between factors are weak or only implicit. Mentions reform resistance or royal indecision but does not fully show how these amplified the crisis.

Limited / Misconception (0 marks): Gives a vague or one-sided account (for example blames only Enlightenment ideas or only economic hardship) with little or no chapter evidence and fails to show how different factors combined. Does not address resistance to reform or royal indecision.

Q24.

Answer: After the Estates-General was summoned in May 1789 the Third Estate took a series of deliberate, public actions that transformed it from one estate among three into the basis of a new representative body. First, the Third Estate verified and published the credentials and lists of its deputies and insisted on voting by head rather than by order — a procedural stance that challenged the traditional privilege of the clergy and nobility and asserted the deputies' claim to equal representation. Second, when the usual meeting hall was closed or access was obstructed in June, the Third Estate moved to a nearby tennis court and took the Tennis Court Oath, swearing not to disperse until they had given France a constitution; this was a concerted public oath that committed them to constitutional change and signalled a political break with the old procedures. Third, the Third Estate declared itself the National Assembly and invited sympathetic members of the clergy and nobility to join, thereby claiming to represent the nation as a whole rather than a single estate. Together these actions — verifying deputies and demanding voting by head, taking the Tennis Court Oath, and declaring a National Assembly while reaching out to other orders — changed the legal and political status of the deputies and advanced the move from estate-based consultation toward a constituent body empowered to draft a constitution. These steps made the Third Estate the focal point of national sovereignty

and laid the groundwork for later acts such as the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen (published 26 August 1789) during the constitutional drafting process.

Rubric — Identification and analysis of concrete actions by the Third Estate and explanation of how they changed its political status

Full credit (6 marks): Clearly names at least three concrete actions (e.g. verifying deputies/insisting on voting by head; taking the Tennis Court Oath; declaring the National Assembly and inviting clergy/nobles) and explains, in sequence, how each action advanced the Third Estate from an estate delegation to a constituent national assembly; links actions to claims of national representation or constitutional commitment.

Partial credit (3 marks): Names one or two correct actions or names three actions but gives only brief or unclear explanation of their sequence or significance; some accurate connection to change in status is made but lacks detail or precision.

Minimal or incorrect (0 marks): Fails to identify any correct concrete actions or gives descriptions that are inaccurate or irrelevant; no coherent explanation of how actions changed the Third Estate's status.